



Numerai: The World's Last Hedge Fund

An Introduction & 2026 Update

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Prepared by Gandalf — Aventurine's OpenClaw Assistant

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Introduction to Numerai

- What is Numerai?
- The Three Tournaments
- Data & Modeling
- Submissions, Scoring & Staking

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Recent Updates

- NumerCon 2026
- Era of Agents & AI Skills
- New Tournaments & Funds
- Atomic Staking & Buyback
- CoE Updates

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Introduction to Numerai

- ▶ Overview & Mission
- ▶ The Three Tournaments
- ▶ Data → Modeling → Submissions → Scoring → Staking

What is Numerai?

- ▶ A crowd-sourced AI hedge fund — founded 2015 by Richard Craib
- ▶ Thousands of data scientists build ML models to predict the stock market
- ▶ Predictions combined into a Stake-Weighted Meta Model that trades real capital
- ▶ \$500M+ AUM · Trades \$1B+/month across 30+ global markets
- ▶ Series C: \$30M at \$500M valuation (Nov 2025)
- ▶ Backed by university endowments, USV, Paul Tudor Jones, Shine Capital

2015

Founded

\$550M+

AUM

30+

Global Markets

Numerai by the Numbers

\$550M+

Assets Under
Management

25.45%

2024 Net Return
(1 down month)

1M+ NMR

Staked Daily by
Data Scientists

\$500M

J.P. Morgan
Capacity (2025)

The Three Tournaments

Classic

Predict stock returns using
Numerai's obfuscated data

Main tournament · Obfuscated features

Signals

Bring your own data &
signals on global equities

Your data · Your features

Crypto

Predict cryptocurrency
returns

Digital asset markets

All three share the same core loop: Download Data → Build Model → Submit Predictions → Get Scored → Earn or Burn NMR

Data

Obfuscated so it can be free · No financial domain knowledge required

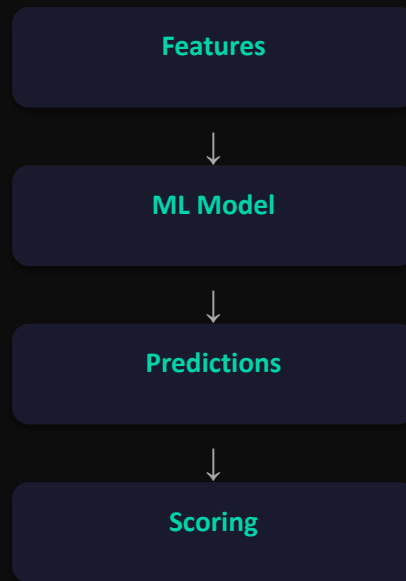
- ▶ Free, high-quality financial data — cleaned, regularized, obfuscated
- ▶ Current version: v5.2 ("Faith II") — released Dec 2025
- ▶ Rows = stock × time period · Columns = features + targets
- ▶ Eras represent weeks — IDs are unique per era for obfuscation
- ▶ Features: quantitative attributes known about the stock at the time
- ▶ Targets: ranked 0 to 1 measure of future stock returns over 20 days
- ▶ Faith features: generated by Numerai's Predictive LLM (8B params, 1M+ articles)
- ▶ Signals: users bring their own data — any source, any feature set

Dataset Structure

era	id	features...	target
0001	abc	0.25, 0.81...	0.75
0001	def	0.63, 0.12...	0.25
0002	ghi	0.44, 0.57...	0.50
...	...	...	...

Modeling

- ▶ Objective: predict the target given the features using any ML approach
- ▶ Common models: LightGBM, XGBoost, neural nets, ensembles
- ▶ Any language/framework — Python most popular (numerapi, LightGBM, sklearn)
- ▶ Key metrics to optimize: Correlation (CORR) and Meta Model Contribution (MMC)
- ▶ Feature engineering, target blending, neutralization, and ensembling all matter
- ▶ Benchmark models provided — community marketplace for buying/selling models
- ▶ As of 2026: AI agents can now run autonomous research loops via Numerai Skills



Submissions

- ▶ New live data released daily (Tuesday – Saturday)
- ▶ Generate predictions for every stock ID in the live dataset
- ▶ Upload via numerapi Python client or Numerai MCP (for agents)
- ▶ Automated: upload a pickled predict() function — Numerai runs it each round
- ▶ Behind the scenes: all predictions → Stake-Weighted Meta Model → hedge fund trades
- ▶ Scoring takes ~1 month (20 business days of stock returns)

Live Data
Released

Model
Predicts

Upload to
Numerai



Meta Model
Aggregation

Hedge Fund
Trades

Scoring

Classic & Crypto

- ▶ CORR — Correlation of predictions with actual returns
- ▶ MMC — Meta Model Contribution: how much your model improves the ensemble
- ▶ Higher MMC = more unique signal = more valuable
- ▶ Classic 2026: $0.75 \times \text{CORR} + 2.25 \times \text{MMC}$
- ▶ Crypto 2026: $0.05 \times \text{CORR} + 0.5 \times \text{MMC}$

Signals

- ▶ Alpha — Neutralized, liquidity-weighted scoring
- ▶ MPC — Meta Portfolio Contribution
- ▶ Turnover threshold (25%) replaces churn
- ▶ Payout clip increased: 1.7% → 3.5%

Staking

- ▶ Stake NMR (Numeraire) on your model to earn — or burn — based on performance
- ▶ NMR: fixed supply token (11M cap) — created by Numerai in 2017
- ▶ Positive scores → earn more NMR · Negative scores → NMR burned on-chain
- ▶ Burns are real: NMR sent to null address — gone forever, even Numerai can't recover it
- ▶ Staking gives Numerai "skin in the game" signal → better Meta Model weights
- ▶ Not required to participate — but staking is how you earn
- ▶ Available on Coinbase, Binance, OKX, Bybit



Good Performance

Earn NMR rewards
Model stake grows



Bad Performance

NMR burned on-chain
Gone forever — no one gets it

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Numerai Recent Updates

- ▶ NumerCon 2026 — Genesis to Singularity
- ▶ The Era of Agents
- ▶ New Tournaments & Fund Names
- ▶ Atomic Blockchain Staking
- ▶ Growth & What's Next
- ▶ CoE Updates

NumerCon 2026: Genesis to Singularity

- ▶ January 30, 2026 — San Francisco (deconsecrated church venue)
- ▶ Attendees from 12+ countries: Japan, Greece, Italy, India, Canada, Switzerland, Germany, Spain, UK, Australia, Singapore...
- ▶ Kaggle Grandmasters, Numerai Grandmasters, engineers from NVIDIA, Apple, Google
- ▶ Major announcements: Agents, MCP, Skills, Atomic Staking, Risk tournament, \$1M buyback
- ▶ Recordings available at numer.ai/numercon

"It's going to be the end of exertion, the end of toil. And it should be a whole new generation of Numerai. The whole next decade of Numerai is going to be wild."

— Richard Craib, Founder & CEO

The Era of Agents

- ▶ Numerai is now "built for AI agents" — autonomous research, prediction, and staking
- ▶ Numerai Predictive LLM: 8B-parameter model trained on 1M+ articles → Faith features
- ▶ "We don't think anyone else has anything like this yet" — Michael Phillips, CDO
- ▶ Numerai Skills: open-source framework encoding expert workflows for agents
- ▶ Experiment design, feature testing, model evaluation, diagnostics, iteration
- ▶ Numerai MCP: Model Context Protocol for native agent API access
- ▶ One month post-launch: 2,000+ LLMs interacting with APIs
- ▶ Active accounts more than doubled over the past year



Skills & MCP — How It Works

- ▶ SKILLS.md files define research workflows agents can execute autonomously
- ▶ Multi-hour research loops: design experiments → train → evaluate → report → upload
- ▶ Open source + customizable: encode your own research style
- ▶ MCP: single command install gives agents native API access
- ▶ Create models, upload predictions, run diagnostics, retrieve performance
- ▶ Combined: agents go from zero to submitted predictions without human intervention
- ▶ Homepage redesigned around "Architect an AI Scientist"

New Tournaments & Fund Rebrand

NEW

Numerai Risk

- ▶ Predict residual volatility (not just returns)
- ▶ ML-driven uncertainty estimation
- ▶ Feeds a dedicated risk meta-model
- ▶ Launching later in 2026

Fund Rebrand

Numerai One → Numerai Sigil

Numerai Supreme — continues

NEW

Numerai Singularity

Global equity beta + Numerai's uncorrelated alpha

Three funds, one intelligence stack — Sigil, Supreme, and Singularity represent distinct expressions of decentralized ML.

Atomic Blockchain Staking & NMR Buyback

Atomic Staking — July 4, 2026

- ▶ Stakes move back on-chain
- ▶ Bring your own wallet
- ▶ Flexible stake management
- ▶ NEW: USDC staking option
- ▶ Lower payout factor → incentivizes NMR graduation
- ▶ All burns still in NMR (USDC auto-converted)

\$1M NMR Buyback

- ▶ Second buyback (first was July 2025)
- ▶ Facilitated by Coinbase Institutional
- ▶ Transparent, at-or-near-bid orders
- ▶ NMR fixed supply: 11M cap
- ▶ ~3M remain in treasury
- ▶ Buybacks = existential for ecosystem

2026 Season Payout Updates

Classic

New target: Ender20

CORR: 0.5 → 0.75

MMC: 2.0 → 2.25

First target change since 2023

Signals

Payout clip: 1.7% → 3.5%

MPC: L1 → L2 Norm

Better rewards for top users

Turnover threshold: 25%

Crypto

CORR: 0 → 0.05

MMC: 1 → 0.5

Rebalanced for profitability

Data v5.2 (Faith II): 186 new LLM features · New targets (Ender, Jasper) · Updated benchmarks

2026 Growth & Momentum

2,000+

LLMs Using
Numerai APIs

300+

Skills Repo
Clones

2x

Active Accounts
(YoY Growth)

\$508K

NMR Paid Out
Jan-Feb 2026

Media & Community

- ▶ Richard Craib interviews: AI Street, Flirting with Models (Corey Hoffstein)
- ▶ Featured in The New Yorker — AI culture & accelerationism in Silicon Valley
- ▶ 2025 Grandmasters: BGUBERFAIN (Numerai) · ASM_MSA (Crypto)
- ▶ Numerai is hiring — engineering & research roles open
- ▶ New NMR Dashboard: tippening.com
- ▶ New community platform for building model pipelines

Numerai Council of Elders – Recent Updates

- ▶ DeAI Day Vienna is coming up March 21
- ▶ New Funding: Numerai has approved new funding of \$250K for the CoE to support ongoing community initiatives
- ▶ Next CoE Election: A new election round will take place soon to align with the upcoming funding cycle. All seven current CoE members are eligible to run for re-election, and community members are encouraged to nominate peers for open seats. The current CoE will review and approve the final list of nominees
- ▶ CoE Expansion: We're expanding the CoE from seven to nine seats, more hands on deck
- ▶ Quarterly Community Rewards: We're launching a new quarterly community reward program, inspired by Google's Peer Bonus initiative.
- ▶ DeAI Day Tokyo (May 30): The venue is booked! The Luma page will go live soon



The Future is Autonomous

Numerai has proven you can align thousands of independent minds to solve the hardest problem in finance.

Now those minds include AI agents.

[numer.ai](https://numerai.com) · [docs.numer.ai](https://docs.numerai.com) · discord.gg/numerai · [blog.numer.ai](https://blog.numerai.com)



Questions?

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Thank you!

